

# USA Swimming CFO Cory Hilliard arrested for allegedly embezzling Colorado athletics money



Cory Hilliard is the second recently-hired executive to plunge USA Swimming into scandal. Michael Reaves / Getty Images



By **Matt Moret**

Aug. 11, 2026 3:20 am GMT+3

[Share full article](#)



[40](#)

USA Swimming put CFO Cory Hilliard on leave Monday following his arrest on allegations he embezzled nearly \$10,000 while working for the University of Colorado's athletics program.

[Boulder police said in a statement](#) announcing the arrest that the Boulder District Attorney's Office has filed felony charges of theft and embezzlement of public property, as well as a misdemeanor charge of first-degree official misconduct.

Hilliard served as the administrator of Colorado's Nike Elite program from 2021 to 2025, managing funds from the sportswear giant's program to provide high school athletes with mentorship and equipment.

As part of his role, Hilliard was tasked with "managing employee product benefit allocations." However, investigators allege Hilliard stole \$9,510.50 for his personal use, a violation that Colorado's athletics program uncovered through an internal 2025 audit.

---

#### TOP LEAGUE CONTENT

---

---

---

---

---

"This morning, we became aware that Cory Hilliard was arrested on charges of financial impropriety related to his time with the University of Colorado Boulder Athletic Department," USA Swimming said in a statement to *The Athletic*. "We

immediately placed Cory on leave and terminated all access to any company data and financial controls. We are now conducting an investigation.”

A spokesperson for Colorado’s athletics department said the university had no comment beyond the DA’s announcement.

This is USA Swimming’s second hiring scandal in as many years. The group hired Chrissi Rawak, the former athletics director at Delaware, as its new CEO in February 2025. Nine days later, Rawak pulled out from the role after USA Swimming discovered she had not disclosed a report involving her from the U.S. Center for SafeSport, which investigates abuse and misconduct in athletics.

Fallout from the Rawak misstep rippled across the swimming community, including from 23-time Olympic gold medalist Michael Phelps, [who called for “systemic change”](#) within USA Swimming. Kevin Ring, formerly the president of sports marketing firm Legends of Golf, took over as CEO in September 2025. USA Swimming has not yet announced a plan to replace Hilliard.

**Matt Moret** is a Staff Editor for The Athletic's news team. Prior to joining The Athletic, he worked as the statewide morning news editor for Colorado Public Radio and Denverite. He was also a digital editor for the Pittsburgh Post-Gazette. He's originally from the Philadelphia area.

+ Follow

Tagged To: [Olympics](#), [Colorado Buffaloes](#)

YOUR NEXT READ

LATEST LEAGUE STORIES

---

## LATEST HEADLINES

---



AUG 11, 2026

### Connections: Sports Edition

Find the hidden link between sports terms

Play today's puzzle >

### What did you think of this story?



MEH



SOLID



AWESOME

---

#### National

Boxing  
Bundesliga  
Champions League

Men's Olympic Ice Hockey  
Mixed Martial Arts  
MLB

#### US

Arizona  
Atlanta  
Baltimore

Memphis  
Miami  
Minnesota

#### Canada

Calgary  
Edmonton  
Montreal

#### Subscribe

Start Subscription  
Buy a Gift  
Group Subscriptions

|                            |                            |              |               |                      |                      |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|--------------|---------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Championship               | MLS                        | Bay Area     | Nashville     | Ottawa               | <b>HQ</b>            |
| College Football           | Motorsports                | Boston       | New Orleans   | Toronto              | About Us             |
| College Sports             | NASCAR                     | Buffalo      | New York      | Vancouver            | Careers              |
| Copa America               | NBA                        | Carolina     | Oklahoma      | Winnipeg             | Code of Conduct      |
| Copa del Rey               | NFL                        | Chicago      | Oregon        |                      | Editorial Guidelines |
| Cricket                    | NHL                        | Cincinnati   | Orlando       | <b>Partners</b>      | Advertise            |
| Culture                    | NWSL                       | Cleveland    | Philadelphia  | Collectibles by eBay | Business Inquiries   |
| Cycling                    | Olympics                   | Columbus     | Pittsburgh    | Odds by Betfair      | Press Inquiries      |
| Europa League              | Opinion                    | Dallas       | Sacramento    | Tickets by Viagogo   |                      |
| European Championship      | Peak                       | Denver       | San Antonio   |                      | <b>Support</b>       |
| FA Cup                     | Premier League             | Detroit      | San Diego     | <b>Play Center</b>   | FAQ                  |
| Fantasy Baseball           | Sailing                    | Houston      | Seattle       | Connections: Sports  | Forgot Password?     |
| Fantasy Basketball         | Scottish Premiership       | Indiana      | St. Louis     | Connections: Soccer  | Contact Us           |
| Fantasy Football           | Serie A                    | Jacksonville | Tampa Bay     |                      | Terms of Service     |
| Fantasy Hockey             | Football                   | Kansas City  | Utah          | <b>Editions</b>      |                      |
| Fantasy Premier League     | Sports Betting             | Las Vegas    | Washington DC | International        | <b>Newsletters</b>   |
| FIFA Club World Cup        | Sports Business            | Los Angeles  | Wisconsin     | U.S.                 | The Pulse            |
| FIFA Men's World Cup       | Tennis                     |              |               |                      | The Bounce           |
| FIFA Women's World Cup     | Top Sports News            |              |               |                      | The Windup           |
| Formula 1                  | WNBA                       |              |               |                      | Prime Tire           |
| Gaming                     | Women's Champions League   |              |               |                      | Full Time            |
| Global Sports              | Women's College Basketball |              |               |                      | Until Saturday       |
| Golf                       | Women's Euros              |              |               |                      | NFL Newsletter       |
| International Football     | Women's Hockey             |              |               |                      | The Athletic FC      |
| La Liga                    | Women's Olympic Ice Hockey |              |               |                      | MoneyCall            |
| League Cup                 | Women's Soccer             |              |               |                      | Red Light            |
| League One                 | Women's Super League       |              |               |                      | Peak                 |
| League Two                 | World Baseball Classic     |              |               |                      | No Offseason         |
| Ligue 1                    | The Athletic Ink           |              |               |                      |                      |
| Memorabilia & Collectibles | Podcasts                   |              |               |                      |                      |
| Men's College Basketball   | Headlines                  |              |               |                      |                      |

